What does post quantum cryptography cost on drone and robot computers, and how do fielded fleets migrate?

A sourced review with a reproducible hardware benchmark plan

Huda Mueen

Evidence retrieved 2026-10-11 (Asia/Dubai)

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How to read the labels. Published = a number or fact copied from a source that was actually retrieved during this review (source and retrieval date in `data/evidence.csv` and Appendix A). **Host-measured** = run in the research sandbox on an x86 server; never comparable to a microcontroller. **Derived / estimated** = my arithmetic, formula shown. **Inference** = my reasoning, not stated by a source. **Planned** = to be measured on your hardware. No number in this report was measured on a microcontroller, and no estimate is presented as a measurement. Standards and guidance marked *in flux* may have changed after 2026-10-11.

1. Summary

The question. What does it cost to move the computers inside small drones and robots (Cortex-M4/M33-class microcontrollers and similar) to post quantum cryptography (PQC), and how can fleets already in the field migrate?

Headline findings (each is developed and sourced below):

1. **The hard problem is signatures and the frozen trust anchor, not key exchange.** Secrecy is exposed retroactively (harvest-now-decrypt-later), but authenticity is exposed prospectively: a forged firmware image only matters once a capable quantum computer exists *and* devices still trust the classical key. Where the verification key and algorithm sit in an immutable boot ROM or fuses, the scheme must outlive the device (NIST CSWP 39, RFC 9019, draft IR 8547, SP 800-208).
2. **Compute cost on Cortex-M4F is moderate for ML-KEM and ML-DSA verification, large for ML-DSA signing and very large for SLH-DSA signing.** Published pqm4 figures (board and clock ambiguous, see 3.1): ML-KEM-768 decapsulation takes 707,827 cycles in the speed optimised M4F code (derived: 29.5 ms at 24 MHz or 35.4 ms at 20 MHz) and ML-DSA-44 verification 1,421,623 cycles (derived: 59.2 ms at 24 MHz or 71.1 ms at 20 MHz). ML-DSA-44 signing averages 3,943,121 cycles with a long tail. Round-3 SPHINCS+ SHA2-128s signing, the predecessor of SLH-DSA, takes 7,657,558,168 cycles (derived: 319,064.9 ms at 24 MHz or 382,877.9 ms at 20 MHz).

3. **Memory and flash decide feasibility more than cycles.** ML-DSA-44 signing needs 44,816 bytes of stack in the fast M4F code but 5,080 bytes in the stack optimised code, which is 12,134,284 cycles. Verification can be done in 2,712 bytes of stack. Code is 19,592 to 24,844 bytes for the M4F-specific ML-DSA-44 variants.
4. **Sizes, not speed, break the radio links.** An ML-DSA-44 signature is 2,420 bytes; MAVLink 2's signature field is 13 bytes (6-byte tag) and its largest payload is 255 bytes, so one ML-DSA-44 signature fills 10 full frames (derived). Per-message PQ signatures on MAVLink-class telemetry are not workable; session key designs are.
5. **No upstream support in the drone/robot stack yet.** I found no PQC in MAVLink, PX4/ArduPilot signing, the DDS-Security specification, mainline SROS2 or upstream MCUboot. wolfBoot (ML-DSA, LMS/HSS, XMSS, hybrid) and TF-M BL1 (LMS) implement PQ verification, and some vendors claim PQ or LMS verification in parts (press statements, unverified, see 4.7); the PSA Crypto API has a PQC extension (1.4 final, January 2026).
6. **Planning dates already exist.** UK NCSC 2028/2031/2035; EU end-2026 first steps, end-2030 high risk use cases, 2035 broad, and an explicit EU roadmap line that products with a life beyond 2030 should be upgradable to PQC with a post quantum signature path for firmware updates; NIST's *draft* IR 8547 proposes deprecating 112-bit-strength RSA/ECC after 2030 and disallowing all quantum vulnerable public key algorithms after 2035. **No UAE or Gulf algorithm level or embedded-device-level guidance was found**; a UAE National Encryption Policy was approved in November 2025 (policy text not retrieved).
7. **Big evidence holes remain** (section 6): no published ML-KEM/ML-DSA/SLH-DSA cycles on a named Cortex-M33; no final parameter LMS or SLH-DSA cycles on any MCU; no measured energy for the final standards on a Cortex-M; nothing from a flight controller part. The benchmark plan (docs/BENCHMARK_PLAN.md) is built to fill exactly these.

Recommendations in one paragraph. Inventory every cryptographic use and each product's root of trust now; make signature algorithms and sizes configurable (crypto agility); put a PQ-capable verifier (stateful hash based LMS/HSS if you can run an HSM-backed single signer, otherwise ML-DSA) into the *updatable* stage of each bootloader and ship dual (classical plus PQ) signatures; move long secrecy links to hybrid ML-KEM key establishment; for MAVLink-class links authenticate sessions with a PQ/hybrid handshake and keep short symmetric tags per message; treat units with classical only immutable roots as a hardware replacement or gateway decision with a date; and measure before committing hardware.

2. Scope, method and evidence discipline

The protocol was written before any evidence was collected (`docs/PROTOCOL.md`). Four research streams (standards, benchmarks, drone/robot specifics, migration/HNDL) plus two supporting streams (benchmark plan facts, host measurement) were run by separate subagents. Primary sources were preferred; search results were used only to locate sources, and no number comes from a search snippet.

Evidence table. `data/evidence.csv` has 523 rows (431 benchmark and size rows from phase 1, 46 protocol and size rows, and 46 benchmark and size rows added in phase 2 from the author supplied PDFs of ePrint 2025/366 and 2020/470), each with source title, URL, retrieval date, location in the source, and a comparability warning. It is summarised in Appendices A and B. **Comparability rules**: rows share an axis only if operation, parameter set and core family agree; differences in library, compiler, statistic, RAM definition and pre standard versus final parameters are flagged.

Verification. A separate subagent that did not collect the data drew 50 rows with a seeded random draw (seed 20261011) and re-opened each source. Of the 50, 48 could be checked against their source and **0 had a wrong numeric field (0/48 rows; 0/487 fields)**; three location citations were corrected; two rows and 31 field lines could not be verified because the source was blocked from the sandbox. With zero errors in 48 rows the upper 95% bound on the row error rate is about 6% (rule of three: 3/48), so this is evidence of good copying accuracy, not proof of

none. Details: `docs/VERIFICATION.md`.

Deviations (full log in PROTOCOL section 10): research subagents used `curl` through the sandbox's configured egress proxy because interactive fetch approvals went unanswered (TLS verification on, no workaround of any explicit denial); several hosts (eprint.iacr.org, nsa.gov, cisa.gov, some vendor pages) were unreachable and nothing from them is used; one non numeric cell was moved into the warning column and three location only fixes were applied.

Safety scope. Side-channel and fault topics are conceptual and defensive. No attack procedures. No cryptographic primitive was implemented here; the benchmark harness calls pinned, reviewed libraries.

3. Standards status and timelines

All rows retrieved 2026-10-11; "in flux" marks drafts or items moving at that date.

3.1 NIST and the United States

Item	Status as retrieved	Notes
FIPS 203 (ML-KEM), 204 (ML-DSA), 205 (SLH-DSA)	Final, 2024-08-13; errata lists exist for 203 and 204 (**in flux**)	NIST says they "can and should be put into use now" rationale in NIST IR 8545
HQC	Selected 2025-03-11 as a backup KEM; no FIPS yet (**in flux**)	
FN-DSA / FIPS 206 (Falcon)	**No draft published** as of a NIST post dated 2026-09-28 (**in flux**)	NIST still consulting on fixed point arithmetic for signing and key generation; verification does not need floating point
SP 800-208 (LMS/HSS, XMSS/XMSS^MT)	Final, October 2020	names firmware authentication for long lived constrained devices as a use case; key and signature generation only in FIPS 140 Level 3+ hardware modules; "not suitable for general use" because of state management
Draft SP 800-230	Initial public draft, 2026-04-13 (**in flux**)	extra SLH-DSA parameter sets limited to 2^24 signatures per key, aimed at firmware, software and certificate signing
NIST IR 8547 (transition)	Initial public draft, November 2024; still presented as a draft (**in flux**)	112-bit classical signatures deprecated after 2030, all quantum vulnerable public key algorithms disallowed after 2035
SP 800-227 (KEM recommendations)	Final, September 2025	
CSWP 39 (crypto agility)	Final 2025-12-19; update 2026-06-29	defines crypto agility; describes crypto gateways for legacy systems
NSM-10 / OMB M-23-02	Final policy, 2022	2035 goal; prioritised cryptographic inventory

Item	Status as retrieved	Notes
NSA CNSA 2.0, CISA pages	**Not retrieved** (access denied)	**No claim made.** Fetch manually (NEXT_STEPS)

3.2 United Kingdom, European Union and others

- **UK NCSC** (v1.0, 2025-03-20): finish discovery and plan by **2028**, highest priority migration by **2031**, complete by **2035**. It flags industrial IoT as possibly resource constrained and non upgradeable, and notes some vendors already ship LMS/XMSS secure boot.
- **EU Coordinated Implementation Roadmap, Part 1 v1.1** (dated 2025-06-11; page updated 2026-09-03): national strategies and first steps by **end-2026**; high risk use cases by **end-2030**; as many systems as feasible by **2035**; hybrids "whenever feasible and suitable"; **products with an expected lifetime beyond 2030 should be upgradable to PQC, with post quantum signatures on the update mechanism, linked to the Cyber Resilience Act from December 2027**; a use case with transition effort above about 8 years and high impact (securing software updates is the example) is high risk. This is the single most relevant government statement found for drone and robot makers.
- **Germany BSI**: hybrid preferred; TR-02102 version 2026-01, hybrid TLS groups to be added next. **France ANSSI**: hybrid recommended; "not reasonable" to buy non-PQC products after 2030. **Australia ASD**: stop traditional asymmetric cryptography by end-2030, does not recommend hybrids (retrieved via summary). **Canada**: plans by April 2026, 2031 for high priority, 2035 for the rest. **Japan**: government target about 2035 (interim report, Nov 2025). **Singapore**: handbook and readiness index in consultation (Oct-Dec 2025). **South Korea**: KpqC selected HAETAE and SMAUG-T (Jan 2025).
- **IETF**: RFC 10024 (hybrid TLS 1.3 groups X25519MLKEM768, SecP256r1MLKEM768, SecP384r1MLKEM1024; Proposed Standard, August 2026); draft-ietf-tls-mlkem in the RFC Editor queue (**in flux**); RFC 9881 (ML-DSA in X.509); RFC 9964 (ML-DSA in COSE: -48/-49/-50); RFC 8778 (HSS-LMS in COSE: -46); RFC 8554/8391 (LMS, XMSS; Informational); RFC 10033 (state management for stateful hash based signatures); draft SUIT mandatory-to-implement algorithms recommends an HSS/LMS profile and has no ML-DSA profile in the revision read (**in flux**).

3.3 UAE and the Gulf (stated plainly)

Official UAE sources found: a **National Encryption Policy and executive regulation** approved in November 2025 (reported via wire copies of the WAM article; the policy text itself was not retrieved) that requires government entities to prepare approved transition plans from traditional encryption to PQC, overseen by the Cybersecurity Council; a **National Post-Quantum Migration Program** announced the same week (QuantumGate, ATRC); and a **May 2026 agreement** to deploy a Crypto Discovery Tool to requirements set by the UAE National Cryptography Center, using TII libraries. TII also launched a PQC C library and reports co-developing HQC. *Not found:* the text of the policy, any named algorithm list, any hybrid requirement, any deadline year, and any rule specific to drones, robots or embedded devices. Search coverage was English-language only; Arabic sources were not searched. *Rest of the Gulf:* a Saudi central bank (SAMA) circular with inventory deadlines (2026-12-31) and risk assessment deadlines (2027-03-31) is reported only by secondary sources and is **unverified**. For Qatar, Oman, Kuwait and Bahrain no migration guidance was found (Bahrain: a vendor press release about a tooling procurement only). CBUAE, ADGM, DIFC, Dubai Electronic Security Center and TDRA: nothing PQC-specific found. *Implication for you* [inference]: for UAE targets (TII/ATRC, EDGE, Al Ain University) the practical anchors are the national policy (inventory and plan), the EU/UK dates when exporting, and the NIST algorithms; ask the UAE National Cryptography Center which algorithm profile applies to embedded and unmanned systems.

4. What the published numbers say

Everything in this section is published (not measured here) unless it says derived. Setups differ; read the warnings before comparing.

4.1 The comparability warning that matters most

The only maintained benchmark with the final ML-KEM/ML-DSA names on Cortex-M4F is **pqm4** (`benchmarks.csv`, last changed 2025-05-22). Its README says all cycle counts were taken at 24 MHz to avoid flash wait states, but its default board's (NUCLEO-L4R5ZI) benchmark clock path in code is 20 MHz and the CSV does not name the board; two other papers say the pqm4 reference numbers came from an L4R5ZI. **I therefore treat the pqm4 clock as unresolved**; every time figure here is derived at both candidate clocks (24 MHz from the README, 20 MHz from the code of the default board) and is not a claim about any particular board. The board and clock were checked in the project's own files (`data/raw/S6_pqm4_config.md`): the README default board is the NUCLEO-L4R5ZI, the benchmarks.py default platform is the STM32F4 Discovery, and the result files record neither. pqm4 itself carries a notice that it will be archived read only in or after January 2027. pqm4 times with SysTick, not the DWT counter. Its ML-DSA rows are means of 1000 runs and its KEM rows means of 10.

4.2 ML-KEM (FIPS 203) on Cortex-M4F

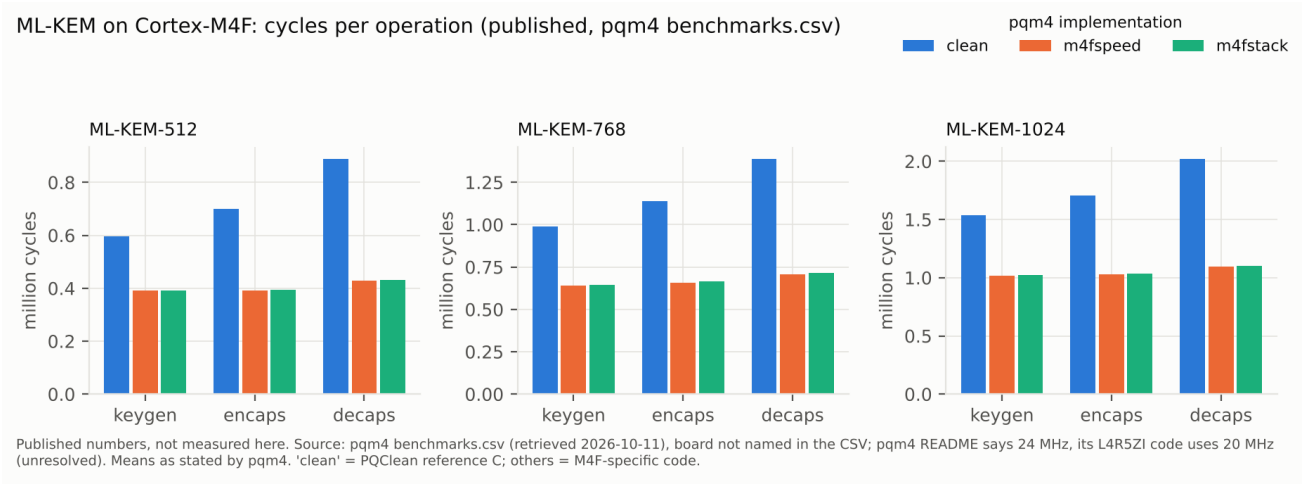


Figure 1: ML-KEM cycles per operation (published, pqm4)

For ML-KEM-768 the reference-C ("clean") code needs 988,722 / 1,138,225 / 1,387,984 cycles for keygen / encaps / decaps with 14,480 bytes of stack on decapsulation; the M4F-specific speed optimised code needs 642,096 / 658,754 / 707,827 cycles (6,452 bytes stack, 16,016 bytes code), and the stack optimised variant 644,195 / 664,654 / 714,194 cycles in only 2,844 bytes of stack. So the stack optimised variant costs about 1.01x the cycles of the speed variant for under half the stack. (ratio of published cycle counts, same benchmark.)

Other published context (different setups, never on one axis with pqm4): wolfCrypt on a Cortex-M4 NUCLEO-F439ZI at 168 MHz reports ML-KEM-768 decaps average 8.333 ms (vendor blog, ML-KEM in assembly); the RP2040 (Cortex-M0+, 125 MHz, preprint) 22.02 ms for decaps from a timer, with cycles derived as time x 125.

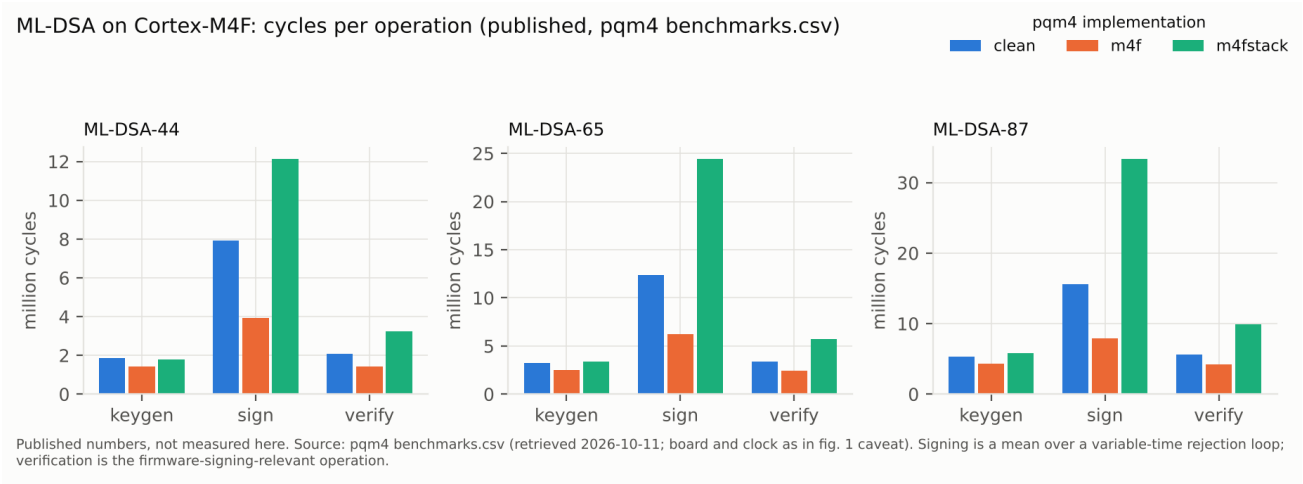


Figure 2: ML-DSA cycles per operation (published, pqm4)

4.3 ML-DSA (FIPS 204) and firmware signature verification

For ML-DSA-44 verification, the operation a secure bootloader performs: 2,063,096 cycles in reference C, 1,421,623 in the M4F-specific code (8,912 bytes of stack) and 3,242,333 in the stack optimised code (2,712 bytes). Signing is far costlier and variable: 3,943,121 cycles (mean) in the M4F code with 44,816 bytes of stack; 12,134,284 cycles in 5,080 bytes in the stack optimised code. ML-DSA-65 verification: 2,415,944 cycles (M4F code).

The tail matters. ML-DSA signing repeats until a candidate passes checks, so its time depends on the data. The RP2040 preprint reports a coefficient of variation near 66-73% for signing, and for its 10,000-run campaign p95 of 421.3 ms and max of 1156.79 ms against a mean of 182.7 ms for ML-DSA-44 (published, Cortex-M0+). A methodology paper (Riou et al., ePrint 2026/1333; abstract only retrieved) argues min/average/max are unsuitable for migration planning. [Inference] For a drone, signing on-board therefore needs a worst case budget, not an average, and verification only designs avoid the problem. mldsa native ships a restartable signing example for bounding run time.

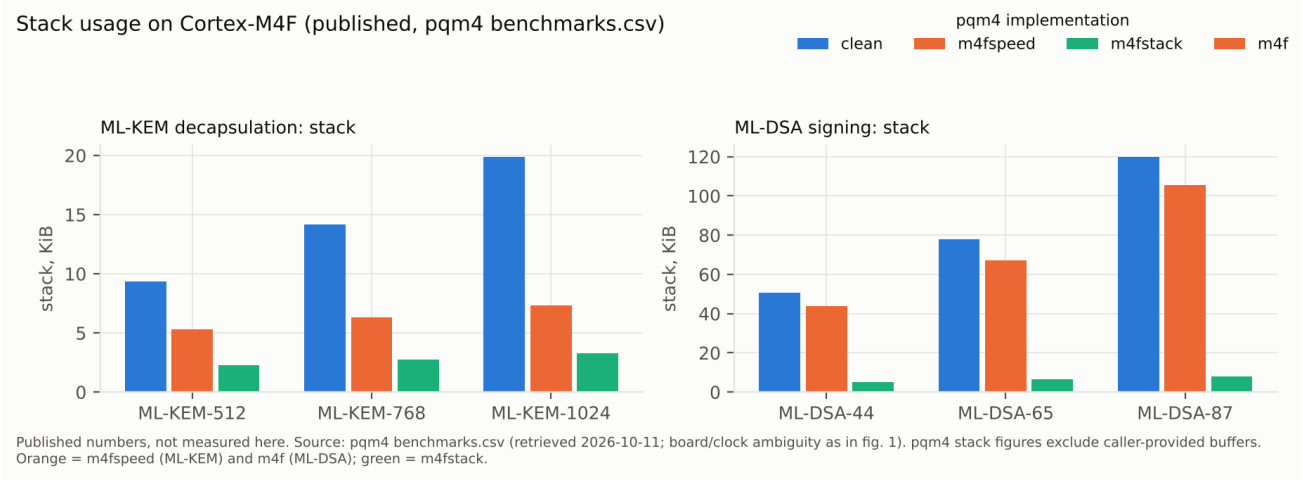


Figure 3: Stack usage on Cortex-M4F (published, pqm4)

Other published points. wolfSSL's blog (Cortex-M4, 168 MHz): ML-DSA-44 verify average 21.913 ms, sign 60.333 ms. On the RP2040 (Cortex-M0+ at 125 MHz): ML-DSA-44 verify 44.0 ms against ECDSA P-256 verify 321.4 ms and RSA-2048 private operation 3393 ms (mbedTLS

built with SDK defaults, not tuned, so the classical side is not a fair optimum). The CHERIoT blog (simulated Ibex RISC-V core) gives ML-DSA-44 verify 3,674,071 cycles.

4.4 SLH-DSA (FIPS 205) and stateful hash based signatures

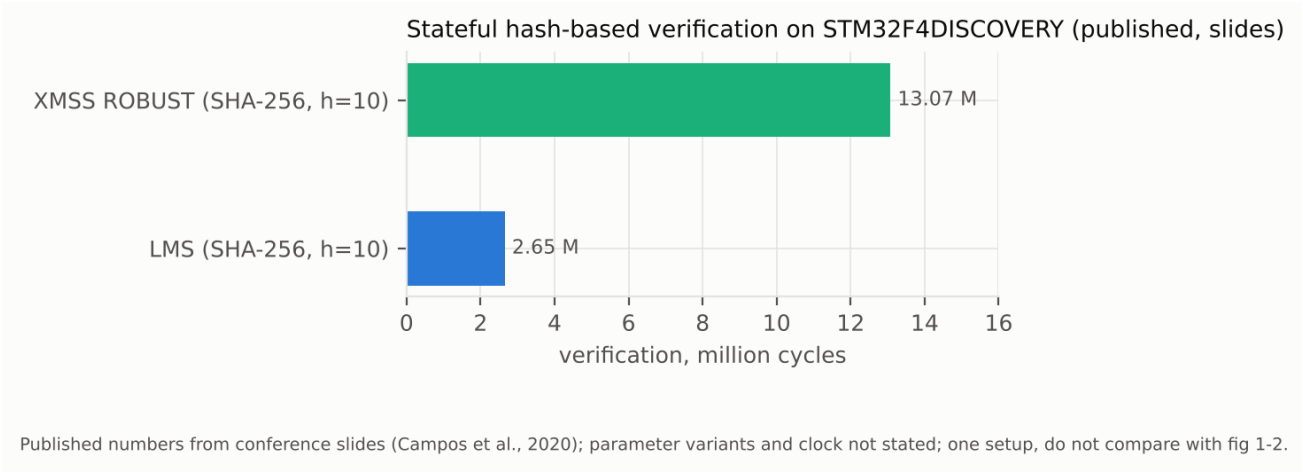


Figure 4: Hash-based verification (published)

No final parameter SLH-DSA or LMS cycle count on any microcontroller was found. What exists:

- **pqm4's SPHINCS+ rows are round-3 "simple" parameter sets, not FIPS 205**, reference C only. SHA2-128s: sign 7,657,558,168 cycles, verify 7,471,794; SHA2-128f: sign 368,575,228, verify 21,923,628. Signatures are 7,856 (128s) and 17,088 (128f) bytes in FIPS 205 (published sizes). [Derived] verification takes 311.3 ms at 24 MHz or 373.6 ms at 20 MHz (128s) and 913.5 ms at 24 MHz or 1,096.2 ms at 20 MHz (128f); [inference] signing on-device is impractical.
- **LMS/XMSS on Cortex-M4** come from conference *slides* (Campos et al., 2020; STM32F4DISCOVERY, clock not stated, pre-RFC-final variants): LMS h5 SHA-256 verify 2,576,515 cycles with 1,044 bytes of stack; LMS h10 verify 2,650,000; XMSS ROBUST h10 verify 13,070,000. The XMSS paper of Bos et al. (FRDM-K64F, 120 MHz) reports 13,850,000 cycles for reference XMSS-SHA2_10_256 verification and 7,870,000 with its speed-up techniques.
- **Boot-time measurements** (wolfSSL blog, STM32H563 at 320 MHz, ~100 KB image, *total boot time, not verification only*; vendor, unverified): SHA2-only baseline 55.662 ms; ECDSA P-256 75.611 ms; ML-DSA-44 82.791 ms; ML-DSA-87 127.807 ms; LMS 1-10-8 207.703 ms; XMSS-SHA2_10_256 189.553 ms; hybrid ECC+ML-DSA-65 341.706 ms. The blog gives 320 MHz for the STM32H563, above the 250 MHz maximum that Zephyr's board page lists for the NUCLEO-H563ZI, so the clock or part naming is doubtful. The same table lists Ed25519 at 1589.512 ms, which shows how much an unoptimised configuration can distort comparisons.
- **TF-M BL1** states its LMS software verifier is about 3 KiB versus at least 6.5 KiB for RSA (vendor documentation claim).

4.5 Sizes

ML-DSA-44/65/87 signatures are 2,420 / 3,309 / 4,627 bytes and public keys 1,312 / 1,952 / 2,592 bytes (FIPS 204). ML-KEM-768 encapsulation key 1,184 and ciphertext 1,088 bytes (FIPS 203). Ed25519 signature: 64 bytes (PX4 docs). X25519MLKEM768 key shares: 1,216 (client) and 1,120 (server) bytes (RFC 10024).



Figure 5: Key and signature sizes

4.6 Energy

Published *measured* energy exists only for **pre standard** Kyber/Dilithium on a Cortex-M4 at 96 MHz (Saarinen 2020) and on an ESP32 (2026 paper). Example on the Cortex-M4 (NUCLEO-F411RE, 96 MHz): Kyber768 decaps 876.3 uJ; Dilithium2 verify 1,121 uJ; Dilithium2 sign 3,777 uJ; ECDSA P-256 verify 4,142 uJ (same paper). On the ESP32 (240 MHz): Dilithium2 sign 18,040 uJ. The RP2040 energy figures (for example 19,220 uJ for ML-DSA-44 keygen+sign+verify) are **a datasheet model estimate, not a measurement**, by the source's own statement. **No measured energy for the final ML-KEM/ML-DSA/SLH-DSA on a Cortex-M was found.**

4.7 Hardware acceleration

Only FPGA and ASIC results were found (RISQrypt on an Artix-7 co-design: Kyber768 decaps 35 thousand cycles, 109 thousand masked; Dilithium3 verify 126 thousand cycles; Adams Bridge in 5 nm synthesis; a PQShield NTT block at 258 cycles per 256-point transform). Vendors claim PQC acceleration or verification in ST (X-CUBE-PQC with the STM32 crypto accelerator), Microchip (MEC175xB: ML-DSA, LMS verification and ML-KEM "in immutable hardware"; Cortex-M4F at 96 MHz) and Infineon (PSOC Control C3: LMS verification with SHA hardware). **None of these vendor pages gives cycle counts or a verifiable device list**; treat them as leads to ask suppliers about. A 2025 Mbed TLS vulnerability (CVE-2025-49600, an LMS-verification bug with unchecked hash return values) is a reminder that offload paths must fail closed: a failing hash accelerator could let an invalid LMS signature be accepted.

4.8 Classical baselines

Published classical numbers on matching devices exist (ECDSA/ECDH on the F411RE at 96 MHz; wolfCrypt RSA/ECC on the F439ZI; RP2040 mbedTLS). No raw X25519 or Ed25519 operation times were found, and pqm4 has no classical baselines. Cross-paper ratios are therefore not computed: setups differ.

5. Drone and robot constraints

5.1 MAVLink signing

MAVLink 2 signing sets an incompatibility flag and appends **13 bytes**: 1 link ID, 6-byte timestamp (10 microsecond units since 2015-01-01) and a 6-byte tag, the first 48 bits of a SHA-256 over the secret key, header, payload, CRC, link ID and timestamp. The key is **32 bytes, shared by all parties**; provisioning is out of band or via `SETUP_SIGNING` over a secure link such as USB. Maximum payload 255 bytes; maximum signed packet 280 bytes. PX4 documents that signing gives no confidentiality, no per party identity, and no automatic key rotation, that a few messages (HEARTBEAT, RADIO_STATUS, ADSB_VEHICLE, COLLISION) are always accepted unsigned, and that without a key everything is accepted. ArduPilot's page says telemetry downlink and USB are unaffected by signing. A 2026 CVE record notes the baseline problem: MAVLink needs no authentication by default. [Inference] A symmetric 256-bit-key MAC is not what a quantum computer breaks directly; what is exposed is the **provisioning path** and any asymmetric steps around it, and the fact that nothing in the protocol can carry a PQ signature. *Found absent:* no PQC-specific MAVLink standard, no PX4/ArduPilot documentation of PQC signing, no peer reviewed measurement of PQC on a MAVLink flight controller. Community and preprint items exist (an ArduPilot forum RFC proposing authentication as first class messages and a KpqC feasibility preprint, ePrint 2026/2343, abstract only); the forum author's numbers are unverified and are not used. Phase 2 addition: the MAVLink issue tracker records the maintainers' stated position. In mavlink/mavlink issue 2525 (closed 2026-06-30, https://github.com/mavlink/mavlink/issues/2525) a maintainer said there is no post quantum roadmap and the project does not think it needs one, that signatures recorded now are not a harvest risk, and that carrying about 4.6 kB per message is not acceptable; issue

2527 (closed 2026-06-24) was a third party wire format proposal that maintainers said falls outside the existing extension mechanisms. This is a project statement as read on 2026-10-12, not a standard.

5.2 Secure boot and OTA

- **PX4**: Ed25519 (monocypher), 32-byte key, 64-byte signature, fits a 128 KB bootloader sector; **ArduPilot**: bootloader can embed up to 10 public keys (the docs read do not name the algorithm; its tooling depends on monocypher, so an Ed25519-class scheme is likely, an inference). Both are classical signature checks in a fixed size bootloader region, which is the immutable-first-stage case.
- **MCUboot**: signature types listed are RSA, ECDSA and Ed25519; **no PQC identifier found** in the main branch design doc and release notes (issue and PR search was blocked, so absence is not proof).
- **wolfBoot** v2.0.0 added LMS/HSS and XMSS (2023-11-07), v2.3.0 ML-DSA and hybrid (2024-10-31), v2.10.0 (2026-10-01) lists an NXP i.MX RT700 ML-DSA-87 configuration; example headers: 4,840 bytes (ML-DSA-44), 5,288 bytes (2-level LMS). **TF-M BL1** verifies with LMS; **PSA Certified Crypto API** has a PQC extension (1.4 final, 2026-01-28) covering LMS, HSS, XMSS, ML-DSA, SLH-DSA and ML-KEM. **Zephyr 4.4.2** ships only experimental mldsa native (ML-DSA-87, internal) and Mbed TLS LMS verification.
- **SUIT/COSE/Uptane**: identifiers exist (HSS-LMS -46; ML-DSA -48/-49/-50); the SUIT mandatory-to-implement draft recommends an HSS/LMS profile; Uptane 2.1.0 (as read) shows RSA, ECDSA, Ed25519 and no PQC text.
- **Caliptra** (an open source silicon root of trust, datacenter oriented, used here only as a documented pattern): release 1.3 adds a software only ML-DSA-87 identity chain via runtime firmware without ROM change, while the ROM-rooted classical chain stays and the PQ chain does not attest the ROM.

5.3 ROS 2, DDS-Security, micro-ROS

DDS-Security 1.2 (cover marks it not yet final) specifies RSASSA-PSS/PKCS#1 v1.5 (2048-bit), ECDSA P-256/P-384, DHE MODP-2048 and ECDHE P-256/P-384 with AES-GCM/GMAC; a text search found **no post quantum algorithm**. ROS 2 uses it through SROS2 (security off by default; vendor interoperability of secure communication not supported per the tutorial). Research forks exist (PQSec-DDS plugin for Cyclone DDS; a Dilithium3 SROS2 fork and a hybrid Zenoh fork in a thesis; AXON, a non-DDS RMW with X25519MLKEM768 over QUIC whose own authors say peer authentication is not post quantum or even validated in the shipped mode) with **no benchmarks on robot or MCU hardware**. micro-ROS: official security pages could not be fetched; one paper built a classical TLS 1.3 transport (about 20% time overhead for single value messages). I found no PQC micro-ROS work.

5.4 Why sizes break links (derived estimates)

All figures here are **derived**: `chunks = ceil(N / C)`, `t = 8N / R_eff`, with N from published sizes and C, R from published link limits; they ignore headers, retransmission, acknowledgements and contention.

Chunk capacities (published): MAVLink payload 255 B; FTP data 239 B per message (251-byte payload minus a 12-byte header); ENCAPSULATED_DATA 253 B; TUNNEL 128 B; LoRaWAN EU868 DR0-DR2 51 B; US915 DR0 11 B; IEEE 802.15.4 about 81 B worst case with AES-CCM; BLE default 23 B.

Object	Bytes	MAVLink 255 B	FTP 239 B	TUNNEL 128 B	LoRaWAN EU DR0 51 B	802.15.4 81 B	BLE 23 B
ML-DSA-44 signature	2420	10	11	19	48	30	106
ML-DSA-65 signature	3309	13	14	26	65	41	144
ML-DSA-87 signature	4627	19	20	37	91	58	202
LMS H10/W8 signature (computed from RFC 8554)	1452	6	7	12	29	18	64
HSS 2x H5/W8 (wolfBoot docs)	2644	11	12	21	52	33	115
SLH-DSA-128s signature	7856	31	33	62	155	97	342
Ed25519 signature (reference)	64	1	1	1	2	1	3

Serial airtime (SiK default 64 kbps; about 90% usable without error correction, about half with it): an ML-DSA-44 signature takes about 0.34 s, ML-DSA-65 0.46 s and ML-DSA-87 0.64 s with ECC off, double with ECC on; at LoRaWAN EU868 DR0 (250 bit/s nominal) the same signatures need about 77 s, 106 s and 148 s, and a 1% duty cycle then enforces hours of silence. Plot (derived, not measured):

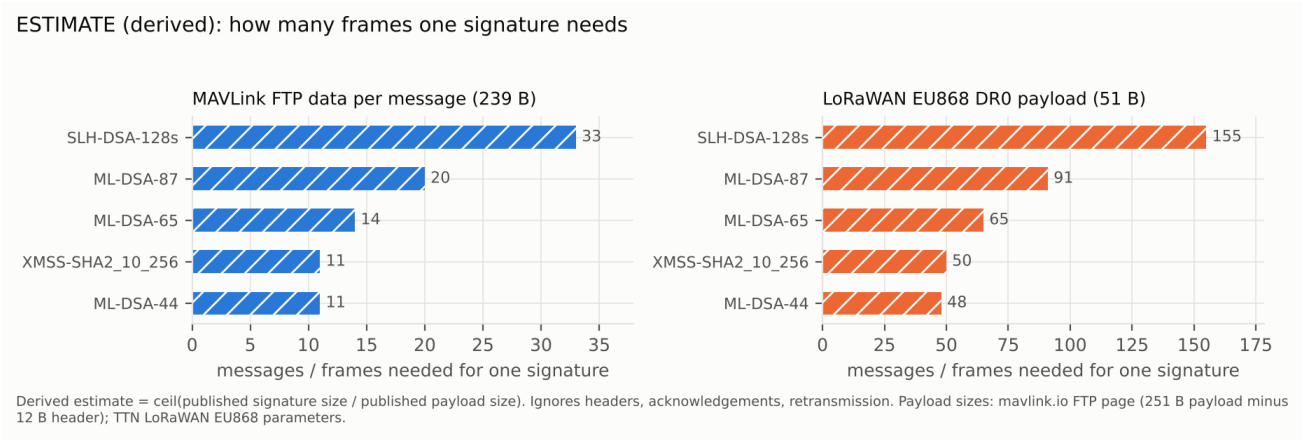


Figure 6: Chunks needed per object (derived estimate)

Conclusion [derived + inference]: per message PQ signatures are impossible in a 13-byte field

and wasteful elsewhere; occasional large objects (a firmware manifest signature, a certificate chain, a hybrid handshake of 2,336 bytes of key shares) can be chunked on slow links but need reassembly state and loss handling that MAVLink has no standard service for.

5.5 Side-channel and fault considerations (conceptual, defensive)

Structured-lattice schemes can leak through timing, power or EM and can be disturbed by faults; protecting an implementation needs scheme specific countermeasures (constant time coding, masking, shuffling, redundancy and validity checks, isolation) [Ravi et al. survey]. Published masking costs: first order masked Kyber decapsulation about 3.1 million cycles on Cortex-M4F, a factor 3.5 over the unprotected optimised code (Bos et al.); masked Kyber768 decaps 2,978,441 cycles including RNG (Heinz et al.); in an FPGA co-design masked Kyber768 decaps is 3.1x and masked Dilithium3 signing 2.6x the unmasked cost (RISQrypt Table 8, ratio derived). For stateful hash based signatures the danger is operational (reusing a one time key); SP 800-208 requires the state to be committed to non volatile memory before a signature is exported. [Inference] A captured drone is physically accessible, so these classes matter mainly for keys that live on the vehicle; a verify only device holding public keys has a smaller exposure than one that signs.

6. What is not known (and what that means)

Gap	Consequence	Where addressed
No ML-KEM/ML-DSA/SLH-DSA cycles on a **named Cortex-M33**	cannot say what moving from M4F to M33 changes	E1 on NUCLEO-U575ZI-Q
No **final parameter LMS/SLH-DSA** cycles on any MCU	firmware signing choice rests on slides and round-3 data	E2
No **measured energy** for final standards on a Cortex-M	battery impact unquantified	E3
pqm4 board/clock unresolved; project to be archived	no stable maintained baseline	E1 reproduces pqm4 rows on the L4R5ZI
No flight controller (Cortex-M7) numbers		later E1 on a Pixhawk-class board
No PQC in MAVLink/DDS-Security/MCUboot upstream	migration needs wrappers or forks	playbook phases 2-3
Vendor ROM/accelerator claims unverified	hardware replacement decisions need written vendor answers	playbook phase 0/4

7. Harvest-now-decrypt-later: what needs secrecy and what needs authenticity

Sourced framing. NIST draft IR 8547 and the CISA/NSA/NIST fact sheet describe harvest-now-decrypt-later for confidentiality; IR 8547 says authentication has no harvest analogue because it stays secure as long as the algorithms and keys are secure when authentication is performed; Banegas et al. state that a quantum breakthrough at time T does not affect signatures made before T but allows forging after T. The Mosca inequality (from GRI 2025 and IR 8547): trouble if shelf life X plus migration time Y exceeds the time Z to a cryptographically relevant quantum computer.

The EU roadmap treats confidentiality needs beyond about 10 years as high risk. NCSC notes that for field OT sensors integrity is likely critical while confidentiality may not need strong protection.

Timeline uncertainty (no date asserted). The Global Risk Institute 2025 survey of 26 experts put a cryptographically relevant quantum computer as "quite possible (28-49%)" within 10 years and likely (51-70%) within 15 (expert opinion, broad bins). Resource estimates keep falling: Gidney 2025 estimates RSA-2048 factoring in under a week with under one million noisy qubits (under stated hardware assumptions); a 2026 Google whitepaper (abstract only) reports fewer than about 1,200 logical qubits for 256-bit ECDLP. These are engineering estimates, not forecasts; use agency dates (NCSC, EU, NIST draft) as planning deadlines.

Classification of drone/robot data (inference; replace the lifetimes with your own).

Asset	Confidentiality lifetime	Authenticity lifetime	Priority
Telemetry (attitude, battery, position)	short; long if it reveals people or sensitive sites	short	low (secrecy), medium if tracks are sensitive
Video / imagery	medium to long (people, facilities, infrastructure)	short to medium (evidence needs provenance)	**high secrecy**
Mission plans, geofences	medium to long for sensitive operations	short per mission	medium
Maps / point clouds / site models	**long**	medium to long (poisoned maps)	**high**
Customer and site data	**long** (contractual, 10+ years)	medium to long	**high**
Firmware images	medium (low if public)	**very long**: the verification key outlives the device	**high authenticity**
Commands	short	short per command; key trusted for long	medium, via key provisioning
Long-term keys and provisioning secrets	lifetime of what they protect	fleet lifetime	**high**
Logs	short to long	medium to long (forensics)	medium
Device identity / attestation certificates	low (public)	**very long** if ROM- or fuse rooted	**high authenticity**

The practical rule: **move secrecy to hybrid KEM early because delay costs you retroactively; move authenticity where the trust anchor outlives the device, because that is where delay becomes unfixable.**

8. Hybrid, crypto agility and hardware acceleration in practice

- **Hybrid key exchange** is standardised for TLS 1.3 (RFC 10024) and IKEv2 (RFC 9370). Cost: X25519MLKEM768 key shares total 2,336 bytes versus 64 for X25519 (about 36.5x, derived). NIST leaves hybrid use to applications; BSI and ANSSI favour it; ASD does not.
- **Hybrid signatures for firmware**: carry two signatures and verify both (simple, fits current boot designs, cost dominated by the PQ part). wolfBoot, Infineon and Microchip describe this. NIST expects hybrids to be temporary, implying a second transition.

- **Crypto-agility** (NIST CSWP 39): the ability to replace algorithms in protocols, software, hardware and firmware while preserving operations; buffers and storage should not assume algorithm specific sizes; crypto gateways protect legacy components whose crypto cannot change; hardware functions cannot be changed in the field except in reconfigurable logic.
- **Hardware acceleration**: see 4.7; use it, but verify fail closed behaviour and ask vendors for numbers.

9. Decision framework

Tags: **[S1..S5, row]** = from the raw notes in `data/raw/` (each traces to a retrieved URL with retrieval date 2026-10-11); **[evidence S2-xxxx]** = row in `data/evidence.csv`; **[inference]** = my reasoning, not stated by a source. Standards marked *in flux* may have changed since 2026-10-11.

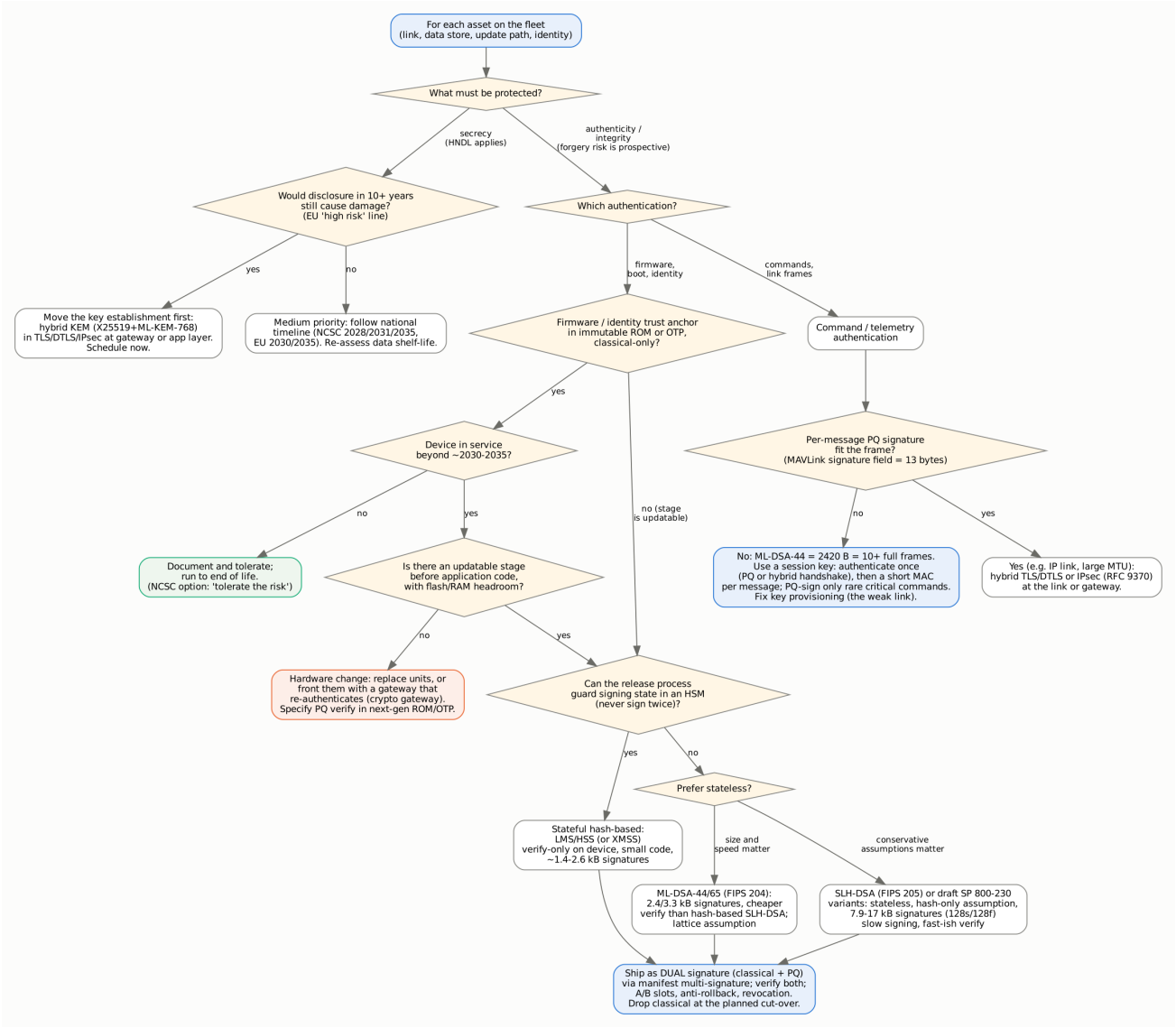


Figure 7: Decision flowchart

(Source file `figures/decision_flow.dot`, also `decision_flow.svg`.)

How to use it

Run the flowchart once per asset class, not once per fleet. A drone has at least five: the **firmware trust anchor** (ROM/OTP key and verifier), the **update path** (manifest, signer), the **command link**, the **data links** (video, telemetry, cloud uplink) and the **device identity**. They get different answers.

The two questions that decide most outcomes

1. **Is the risk retroactive or prospective?** Secrecy has a harvest-now-decrypt-later (HNDL) problem: traffic recorded today can be read later. Authenticity does not: an authentication system stays secure as long as the algorithms and keys are secure when the authentication is performed [S4 A4, IR 8547 ipd 3.1.2]. The authenticity risk is *forgery after a break*, so it matters for keys that stay trusted for a long time, above all verification keys frozen in silicon [S4 A2 CSWP 39 s4.5; A8 RFC 9019; A5 SP 800-208 s1.1].
2. **Can the verifier be changed after shipping?** If the boot ROM or fused/OTP-hashed key and algorithm cannot be updated, the scheme there must stay secure for the device's whole life [S4 CSWP 39 s4.5], and NIST's draft IR 8547 says such devices should be designed to require quantum resistant signatures if they might still be in use when a cryptographically relevant quantum computer exists (draft, in flux) [S4 A4 s3.1.1].

Choosing a firmware signature scheme (verify only device)

Sizes are standard values [evidence S2-0405..0413, S3-036..044]; cycle counts are *published, different setups, not comparable across rows* [evidence S2-0033, S2-0057, S2-0060, S2-0316, S2-0319]. Treat the cycle column as orientation, not a ranking.

Criterion	LMS/HSS (SP 800-208)	XMSS/XMSS^MT (SP 800-208)	ML-DSA (FIPS 204)	SLH-DSA (FIPS 205)
State on signer	**Stateful**: signing a one time key twice allows forgery; key and signature generation only in FIPS 140 Level 3+ hardware modules per SP 800-208 s8.1 [S1 row 12, 13]	same	none	none
Signature size (bytes)	1452 (1-level H10/W8, computed from RFC 8554 formula [S3 8.3]); 2644 (2-level H5/W8, wolfBoot docs)	2500 (XMSS-SHA2_10_256, wolfBoot docs)	2420 / 3309 / 4627 (-44/-65/-87)	7856 (128s), 17088 (128f), 49856 (256f)
Public key	56 B per LMS key (computed)	per RFC 8391	1312 / 1952 / 2592	small (FIPS 205 Table 2)

Criterion	LMS/HSS (SP 800-208)	XMSS/XMSS^MT (SP 800-208)	ML-DSA (FIPS 204)	SLH-DSA (FIPS 205)
Published verify cost on Cortex-M4 (setups differ)	2,576,515 cycles LMS h5 SHA-256 (slides, S2-0316); 2,650,000 h10 (S2-0319)	13,070,000 XMSS ROBUST h10 (S2-0322, slides)	1,421,623 ML-DSA-44 (pqm4 m4f, mean, 24 MHz-labelled; S2-0033)	7,471,794 for round-3 SPHINCS+ SHA2-128s-simple, **not final SLH-DSA** (S2-0060)
Standards / ecosystem	RFC 8554; COSE -46 (RFC 8778); SUIT MTI draft recommends an HSS/LMS profile (in flux) [S3 4.6]; TF-M BL1 uses LMS; wolfBoot, Mbed TLS (verify)	RFC 8391; wolfBoot	RFC 9964 gives COSE -48/-49/-50, **but the SUIT MTI draft -23 has no ML-DSA profile** [S3 4.6]; wolfBoot supports it	draft SP 800-230 (2026-04, in flux) proposes 2^24-signature variants for firmware; wolfCrypt, slhdsa-c (work in progress)
Hardware/ROM claims (vendor, unverified)	Infineon PSOC Control C3 LMS verify; Microchip MEC175xB	–	Microchip MEC175xB ML-DSA	–
Best when	one release authority with an HSM; long lived ROM-adjacent verifier; smallest code and signature	like LMS	many signers or no HSM state discipline; moderate sizes	most conservative assumption; can tolerate large signatures

[inference] For a fleet whose releases come from one build pipeline, LMS/HSS fits best because the state problem sits in the vendor's HSM, not on the airframe. ML-DSA fits where stateful discipline cannot be guaranteed. SLH-DSA is the conservative stateless choice but the heaviest on bytes (and, from the round-3 rows, on cycles).

Hybrid (dual) signatures: do it with two signatures, not one composite

NIST leaves hybrid use to each application and will accommodate hybrids in FIPS 140 validation [S1 row 20]; BSI and ANSSI favour hybrids, ASD does not recommend them [S1 rows 43, 47, 51]. For firmware, the IETF constrained device draft says carrying two separate signatures is simple and fits current secure boot designs, while overall cost stays dominated by the PQ part [S3 5.2; in flux]. wolfBoot implements it (sequential verification, larger headers) [S3 4.2]. Rule: accept an image only if **both** verify, so authenticity holds while either holds. NIST expects hybrids to be temporary, implying a second transition [S4 IR 8547 3.2].

Link and command authentication

- MAVLink 2 signing is a 13-byte field holding a 6-byte truncated SHA-256 tag over a 32-byte shared key [S3 1.1]; an ML-DSA-44 signature is 2420 bytes, i.e. 10 full 255-byte payloads [S3 8.1, derived]. So per message PQ signatures are not feasible; the design space is a PQ/hybrid *session setup* plus a short symmetric tag per message [inference, consistent with a community proposal S3 1.4]. A shared symmetric key is not directly broken by Shor's

algorithm [inference]; what is exposed is how the key reaches the vehicle (manual, over USB/wired link per the guide) and any public key step in provisioning.
- ROS 2 / DDS-Security 1.2 specifies RSA/ECDSA/ECDH and AES-GCM only; no PQC [S3 3.1]. Research forks exist (PQSec-DDS, a Dilithium3 SROS2 fork) without benchmarks [S3 3.4]. [inference] Until the spec changes, protect the robot-to-ground path with a hybrid TLS/IPsec tunnel at the gateway, and keep DDS-Security inside.

What can be done by firmware update vs what needs hardware [inference, built on sourced constraints]

By firmware update (if flash/RAM headroom and an updatable bootloader)	Likely needs hardware change or a gateway
Hybrid KEM in the application link layer	Boot ROM / fused key hash with classical only algorithm and nothing updatable before it
PQ verifier in an updatable second stage bootloader (wolfBoot-class); dual manifest signatures	Secure elements with a fixed algorithm set
Larger headers and certificate chains	Units with no flash headroom: published PQ code is 8-25 kB flash for ML-DSA [S2-0031..0036] and a 5 kB image header for LMS/ML-DSA in wolfBoot examples [S3 4.2]

Worked example of the pattern: Caliptra 1.3 adds a software only ML-DSA-87 identity chain via runtime firmware without ROM changes, but the ROM-rooted classical chain remains and the PQ chain does not attest the ROM [S4 A19]. Not a drone part; shows what a firmware only fix can and cannot cover.

10. Migration playbook

Tags as in DECISION_FRAMEWORK.md. Dates are planning anchors, not predictions: UK NCSC 2028 (discovery, plan) / 2031 (highest priority migrated) / 2035 (done) [S1 row 33]; EU roadmap end-2026 (national first steps) / end-2030 (high risk use cases) / 2035 [S1 row 37] and, for products with lifetime beyond 2030, upgradable to PQC with a post quantum signature path for firmware updates, tied to the Cyber Resilience Act from December 2027 [S1 row 39]; NIST IR 8547 *draft* proposes deprecating 112-bit classical public key algorithms after 2030 and disallowing all after 2035 [S1 row 15, in flux]. **No UAE algorithm level or embedded-device-level deadline was found**; UAE national policy exists (Nov 2025) and tasks government entities to prepare transition plans [S1 row 62-64].

Phase 0: Inventory and classification (start now; 3-6 months)

Do: list every cryptographic use per product line: boot ROM verifier and key location (mask ROM, OTP hash, flash), bootloader (MCUboot, PX4 Ed25519 bootloader, wolfBoot, vendor), update format, MAVLink signing on/off, companion computer TLS/SSH/VPN, DDS-Security, cloud uplink, certificate lifetimes. Record per model: expected service life, free flash/RAM, radio MTU and rate, supplier of each crypto bearing chip. Fill the HNDL table (`docs/REPORT.md` section 7) with real shelf lives. The CISA/NSA/NIST fact sheet specifically warns that firmware/software-update and embedded crypto are missed by discovery tools, so ask suppliers [S4 A3]. Exit: a crypto bill of materials and a per model risk class. Risk: unknown ROM behaviour; mitigate by asking the SoC vendor in writing whether the verifier algorithm or key can change. Rollback: n/a (read only).

Phase 1: Crypto-agility groundwork (6-12 months)

Do: algorithm identifiers everywhere (COSE/SUIT codes exist: HSS-LMS -46, ML-DSA -48/-49/-50 [S3 4.6]); no fixed buffer sizes tied to Ed25519 (64 B) or ECDSA; manifests able to carry multiple signatures (SUIT requirement for multi authorisation [S4 RFC 9124]); signing keys as delegates of a trust anchor [S4 RFC 9124]; anti rollback counters; key revocation; logging without leaking signatures; contract language requiring PQ roadmaps [S4 A3]. CSWP 39 is the reference for agility; its "crypto gateway" is the pattern for legacy units [S4 A2 s4.6]. Exit: a test where a dummy second signature of a different size passes through build, OTA, device and logs. Risk: size assumptions in parsers; scope creep. Rollback: feature flag the new parsing; old path unchanged.

Phase 2: Firmware-signing path (the long pole; 12-24 months)

Do: (a) choose scheme with the flowchart; stateful schemes need an HSM-backed signer, state committed before a signature leaves the module, no backup restore, no parallel signers (SP 800-208, RFC 10033 [S3 6]); (b) ship a PQ-capable verifier in the *updatable* stage (second stage bootloader or update agent) and keep the classical check; (c) dual sign every release; (d) A/B slots so a failed bootloader update cannot brick units (power loss mid update is the main fleet scale hazard [inference]); (e) staged rollout rings (bench, internal fleet, 1%, 10%, all); (f) hardware-fault-safe verification: verification must fail closed if an accelerator errors (an Mbed TLS verification bug in 2025 let an invalid signature pass when a hash accelerator failed [S3 4.4]). Test on your boards using BENCHMARK_PLAN E2/E4 before committing; the published numbers do not cover your parts. Exit: 100% of updatable units verify both signatures; classical only images rejected on pilot ring. Risks: boot time and flash growth (wolfBoot LMS example header 5288 B; vendor measured boot time adds in S2 are not transferable); HSM state error; unrecoverable bricks. Rollback: A/B revert to the last image carrying both signatures; keep the signer's *previous* key trusted until exit; never roll back by restoring a stateful key backup. Note the tension: anti rollback counters block downgrade, so "rollback" means rolling *forward* to a fixed image with a higher counter, or a pre planned signed rollback manifest [inference].

Phase 3: Session keys and links (parallel to Phase 2; 6-18 months)

Do: hybrid key establishment (X25519MLKEM768 etc., RFC 10024, Proposed Standard Aug 2026 [S1 row 52]) on every TLS/DTLS link and gateway; IKEv2 with multiple key exchanges for IPsec (RFC 9370) [S4]; for MAVLink: provision the 32-byte key via a PQ/hybrid-protected channel instead of plain USB-only copying, rotate keys (PX4 documents no automatic rotation [S3 1.2]), keep signing *on* (without it the baseline problem is no authentication at all [S3 1.4 CVE record]); for chunked handshake data over low rate radios, budget airtime (REPORT 5.4). Prioritise long secrecy data (video of facilities, site maps, customer data) first. Exit: all long-lived-secret flows use hybrid KEM; classical only fallback disabled where policy allows. Risk: MTU and fragmentation (X25519MLKEM768 shares total 2336 bytes [S3 8.4]); handshake time on slow radios. Rollback: negotiate, keep classical only as a configurable fallback until exit, log downgrades.

Phase 4: Hardware and procurement (continuous)

New purchases: require verify only PQ in boot ROM or an updatable first stage, a hardware hash or PQ accelerator where vendors offer it (claims only so far: ST X-CUBE-PQC, Microchip MEC175xB, Infineon PSOC Control C3 [S3 4.5]; none verified), flash/RAM headroom (published pqm4 ML-DSA-44 code is 19.6-24.8 kB for the M4F-specific variants (8.2 kB for reference C) and stack 2.7-44.8 kB depending on operation and strategy [S2-0031..0036]). ANSSI says it would not be reasonable to buy products without PQC after 2030 [S1 row 48]. Units that cannot be updated: retire on schedule, gateway them, or document tolerated risk (NCSC lists these options [S4]).

Phase 5: Cut-over and retirement of classical algorithms

Criteria (set in advance): fleet coverage threshold, no classical only supplier left, regulator dates. Then stop accepting classical only signatures, revoke classical anchors, retire dual signing. NIST warns hybrids imply a second transition; plan it [S4 IR 8547 3.2]. Re-check in-flux items first: FIPS 206 (FN-DSA) draft, IR 8547 final, HQC FIPS, SP 800-230 final, FIPS 203/204 errata, SUIT MTI, EU roadmap updates.

Cross-cutting risks

Risk	Why	Mitigation
Stateful key reuse	one time key signing twice permits forgery [S3 6]	HSM, single signer, no restores, RFC 10033 procedures
Bricking at bootloader update	immutable first stage cannot be fixed [S4]	A/B, power fail tests, pilot ring
Standards move	FN-DSA, IR 8547, SUIT MTI in flux	agility, re-check list, avoid pre standard Kyber/Dilithium parameter sets
Side-channel/fault exposure on captured vehicles	keys on-vehicle are physically accessible; masking costs 3.5x for M4F Kyber decaps as published [S3 6]	keep long term signing keys off the vehicle; verify only on device; vendor reviewed libraries
Unmeasured costs	no M33, flight controller or final LMS/SLH-DSA numbers	BENCHMARK_PLAN before committing hardware

11. Benchmark plan (summary; full plan in docs/BENCHMARK_PLAN

No purchase is required (emulator first, then borrowed lab hardware; `docs/NO_PURCHASE_PLAN.md`). Reference boards that a lab may already own (approximate single unit prices seen 2026-10-11, for reference only): NUCLEO-U575ZI-Q (Cortex-M33, $26.35), NUCLEO-L4R5ZI (Cortex-M4F, pqm4's default board, $33.61), optional Raspberry Pi Pico 2 (M33, about $6, needs an SWD probe), Nordic PPK2 for energy ($99.95). Software pinned by commit: mlkem native and mldsa native v2.0.0 (`d1b2fe7...`, `834a90d...`), wolfSSL v5.9.4-stable, wolfBoot v2.10.0, TF-PSA-Crypto v1.2.0. Method: DWT cycle counter at a fixed 0-wait-state clock, stack painting, baseline subtracted code size, deterministic APIs so the RNG is outside the timed region; at least 3 power cycles, medians and percentiles with bootstrap CIs, ML-DSA signing reported as a distribution. Experiments: **E1** ML-KEM/ML-DSA cycles, stack and flash on M33 and M4F (first); **E2** hash based verification (specification only); **E3** energy; **E4** boot time impact in wolfBoot; **E5** link level transfer of signatures and handshakes over real radios. **Status of the code**: the harness (`bench/mcu`) compiles and runs on a PC, labelled *host measurement*; its statistics script (`bench/stats`) was tested on that host output; the power script (`bench/power`) was tested on synthetic traces only. **None has been run on a microcontroller or a real power meter.** Host-measured examples (x86 Xeon VM, liboqs 0.16.0, portable-C variant): ML-KEM-768 decaps about 66 microseconds and ML-DSA-44 verify about 106 microseconds, versus millions of cycles on a Cortex-M; these say nothing about MCU ranking.

12. Limitations

- Evidence is only as good as retrieval: eprint.iacr.org (including the pqm4 and SLOTHY papers), NSA, CISA and several vendor pages were unreachable; their content is not used.

- Many MCU figures come from vendor blogs, preprints and conference slides. They are labelled as such in the table.
- The pqm4 board and clock are unresolved; pre standard Kyber/Dilithium rows are kept out of final standard comparisons.
- Government pages change; items marked *in flux* must be re-checked before relying on them.
- UAE coverage rests on press reports of the national policy, not the policy text; Arabic sources were not searched.
- The decision framework and classifications tagged *inference* are my reasoning and need review by a cryptographer before a product decision.
- The 0/48 verification result bounds copying errors in the table, not the correctness of the sources themselves.

Appendix A. Source register (every source behind a table row)

Retrieved on the date shown; `rows` = number of table rows taken from that source. Per-row locations are in `data/evidence.csv`.

1. Adams Bridge Accelerator: Bridging the Post-Quantum Transition (2 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://eprint.iacr.org/2026/256
2. Benchmarking NIST-Standardised ML-KEM and ML-DSA on ARM Cortex-M0+: Latency, Rejection-Sampling Variance, and Memory on (34 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://arxiv.org/pdf/2603.19340
3. Compact Dilithium Implementations on Cortex-M3 and Cortex-M4 (Greconici, Kannwischer, Sprenkels) (36 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://tches.iacr.org/index.php/TCHES/article/download/8725/8325
4. Drop-In Masked Modular Reduction for ML-DSA: Cutting Side-Channel Cost in the Root-of-Trust (1 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://eprint.iacr.org/2026/711
5. Enabling Microarchitectural Agility: Taking ML-KEM & ML-DSA from Cortex-M4 to M7 with SLOTHY (Abdulrahman, Kannwischer, (24 rows; retrieved 2026-10-12) https://eprint.iacr.org/2025/366.pdf
6. FIPS 203 Module-Lattice-Based Key-Encapsulation Mechanism Standard (NIST) (9 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/FIPS/NIST.FIPS.203.pdf
7. FIPS 203 Module-Lattice-Based Key-Encapsulation Mechanism Standard (published 2024-08-13) (6 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/FIPS/NIST.FIPS.203.pdf
8. FIPS 204 Module-Lattice-Based Digital Signature Standard (NIST) (9 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/FIPS/NIST.FIPS.204.pdf
9. FIPS 204 Module-Lattice-Based Digital Signature Standard (published 2024-08-13) (6 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/FIPS/NIST.FIPS.204.pdf
10. FIPS 205 Stateless Hash-Based Digital Signature Standard (NIST) (12 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/FIPS/NIST.FIPS.205.pdf
11. FIPS 205 Stateless Hash-Based Digital Signature Standard (published 2024-08-13) (6 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/FIPS/NIST.FIPS.205.pdf
12. First-Order Masked Kyber on ARM Cortex-M4 (1 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://eprint.iacr.org/2022/058
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29. RFC 8391 XMSS: eXtended Merkle Signature Scheme (IETF) (6 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc8391.txt
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35. Updated Post-Quantum Benchmarks for ML-KEM and ML-DSA on STM32 (wolfSSL blog) (24 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://www.wolfssl.com/updated-post-quantum-benchmarks-for-ml-kem-and-ml-dsa-on-stm32/
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37. wolfBoot docs/PQ.md (Post-Quantum Signatures) (2 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://raw.githubusercontent.com/wolfSSL/wolfBoot/master/docs/PQ.md
38. XMSS and Embedded Systems: XMSS Hardware Accelerators for RISC-V (Wang, Jungk, Waelde, Deng, Gupta, Szefer, Niederhagen) (9 rows; retrieved 2026-10-11) https://par.nsf.gov//servlets/purl/10112210

Appendix B. Key evidence rows (selected; all 523 rows are in data/evidence.csv)

All rows are **published** numbers. Cycles are copied as published; `sz` = key/signature/share bytes. **Do not compare rows with different core, clock, library, statistic or standard status** (see the comparability_warning column in the CSV; `pre-standard` = round-2/3 Kyber/Dilithium/SPHINCS+, not the final FIPS parameter sets).

id	scheme / parameter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0019	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	988722	10248	5120		final-FIPS-name
S2-0020	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 encaps	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	1138225	13384	5120		final-FIPS-name
S2-0021	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 decaps	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	1387984	14480	5120		final-FIPS-name
S2-0022	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	642096	5396	16016		final-FIPS-name
S2-0023	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 encaps	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	658754	6468	16016		final-FIPS-name
S2-0024	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 decaps	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	707827	6452	16016		final-FIPS-name
S2-0025	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	644195	2820	13320		final-FIPS-name
S2-0026	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 encaps	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	664654	2860	13320		final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parameter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0027	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 decaps	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	714194	2844	13320		final-FIPS-name
S2-0028	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	1874405	38304	8212		final-FIPS-name
S2-0029	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	7925955	51976	8212		final-FIPS-name
S2-0030	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	2063096	36308	8212		final-FIPS-name
S2-0031	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	1426025	38296	19592		final-FIPS-name
S2-0032	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	3943121	44816	19592		final-FIPS-name
S2-0033	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	1421623	8912	19592		final-FIPS-name
S2-0034	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	1799062	4408	24844		final-FIPS-name
S2-0035	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	12134284	5080	24844		final-FIPS-name
S2-0036	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	3242333	2712	24844		final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0037	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	3205533	60832	7724		final-FIPS-name
S2-0038	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	12359056	79624	7724		final-FIPS-name
S2-0039	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	3377305	57736	7724		final-FIPS-name
S2-0040	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	2516006	60824	19328		final-FIPS-name
S2-0041	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	6193171	68872	19328		final-FIPS-name
S2-0042	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	2415944	9888	19328		final-FIPS-name
S2-0043	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	3412622	4408	24120		final-FIPS-name
S2-0044	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	24421526	6616	24120		final-FIPS-name
S2-0045	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	5732397	2712	24120		final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parameter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0055	SPHINCS+ (round-3 'sim sphincs-sha2-128f-simple keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	15742990	2856	4956		pre-standard
S2-0056	SPHINCS+ (round-3 'sim sphincs-sha2-128f-simple sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	368575228	2468	4956		pre-standard
S2-0057	SPHINCS+ (round-3 'sim sphincs-sha2-128f-simple verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	21923628	2664	4956		pre-standard
S2-0058	SPHINCS+ (round-3 'sim sphincs-sha2-128s-simple keygen	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	1007731522	3084	5264		pre-standard
S2-0059	SPHINCS+ (round-3 'sim sphincs-sha2-128s-simple sign	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	7657558168	2556	5264		pre-standard
S2-0060	SPHINCS+ (round-3 'sim sphincs-sha2-128s-simple verify	Board not recorded for, Cortex-M4F,	7471794	1968	5264		pre-standard

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0254	XMSS XMSS-SHA2_10_256 verify (refer-ence ve	NXP FRDM-K64F (Kinetis, Cortex-M4, 120	13850000				n/a
S2-0257	XMSS XMSS-SHA2_10_256 verify (TMTO + ctr t	NXP FRDM-K64F (Kinetis, Cortex-M4, 120	7870000				n/a
S2-0316	LMS LMS w=16 h=5 n=256 hash=SH verify	STM32F4DISCOVERY, Cortex-M4,	26765415	1044			n/a
S2-0319	LMS LMS w=16 h=10 n=256 hash=S verify	STM32F4DISCOVERY, Cortex-M4,	26500080				n/a
S2-0322	XMSS XMSS ROBUST w=16 h=10 n=25 verify	STM32F4DISCOVERY, Cortex-M4,	13070080				n/a
S2-0347	none (hash only) SHA2 only, SIGN=NONE secure boot total bo	STM32H563 (NU-CLEO/dev , , 320		1216	10600		n/a
S2-0349	ECDSA ECDSA P-256, SIGN=ECC256 secure boot total bo	STM32H563 (NU-CLEO/dev , , 320		7632	24784		n/a

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0351	ML-DSA ML_DSA-44 (ML_DSA_LEVEL=2) secure boot total bo	STM32H563 (NUCLEO/dev, , 320		25000	21524	2420	final-FIPS-name
S2-0353	ML-DSA ML_DSA-87 (ML_DSA_LEVEL=5) secure boot total bo	STM32H563 (NUCLEO/dev, , 320		25000	22804	4627	final-FIPS-name
S2-0354	LMS LMS 1-10-8 (LMS_LEVELS=1 L secure boot total bo	STM32H563 (NUCLEO/dev, , 320		1320	13416	1456	n/a
S2-0355	XMSS XMSS-SHA2_10_256 secure boot total bo	STM32H563 (NUCLEO/dev, , 320		9352	14236	2500	n/a
S2-0356	hybrid ML-DSA + ECDSA ML_DSA-65 hybrid with ECDS secure boot total bo	STM32H563 (NUCLEO/dev, , 320		25000	38820	3309	n/a
S2-0399	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 encapsu-lation key si	n/a (stan-dard), ,				1184	final-FIPS-name
S2-0400	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 decapsu-lation key si	n/a (stan-dard), ,				2400	final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parameter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0401	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 ciphertext size	n/a (standard), ,				1088	final-FIPS-name
S2-0405	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 private key size	n/a (standard), ,				2560	final-FIPS-name
S2-0406	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 public key size	n/a (standard), ,				1312	final-FIPS-name
S2-0407	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 signature size	n/a (standard), ,				2420	final-FIPS-name
S2-0408	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 private key size	n/a (standard), ,				4032	final-FIPS-name
S2-0409	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 public key size	n/a (standard), ,				1952	final-FIPS-name
S2-0410	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 signature size	n/a (standard), ,				3309	final-FIPS-name
S2-0411	ML-DSA ML-DSA-87 private key size	n/a (standard), ,				4896	final-FIPS-name
S2-0412	ML-DSA ML-DSA-87 public key size	n/a (standard), ,				2592	final-FIPS-name
S2-0413	ML-DSA ML-DSA-87 signature size	n/a (standard), ,				4627	final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parameter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S3-001	Kyber (round-3, pre-st Kyber768 CCA decapsulation, f	not stated in abstract, Cortex-M4,	2978441				pre-standard
S3-002	Kyber (round-3, pre-st not stated in abstract CCA decapsulation, f	not stated in abstract, Cortex-M4F,	3100000				pre-standard
S3-003	Dilithium (2019 era NI not stated in abstract masked operations (m	not stated in abstract, Cortex-M3,					pre-standard
S3-004	ML-DSA not stated in abstract rejection samplings	not stated in abstract, ,					final-FIPS-name
S3-005	ML-KEM (published as K Kyber768 KeyGen	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	23000				check-source
S3-006	ML-KEM (published as K Kyber768 Enc	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	28000				check-source
S3-007	ML-KEM (published as K Kyber768 Dec	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	35000				check-source

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S3-008	ML-KEM (pub-lished as K Kyber768 Masked-Dec	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	109000				check-source
S3-009	ML-DSA (pub-lished as D Dilithium3 KeyGen	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	120000				check-source
S3-010	ML-DSA (pub-lished as D Dilithium3 Sign	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	480000				check-source
S3-011	ML-DSA (pub-lished as D Dilithium3 Verify	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	126000				check-source
S3-012	ML-DSA (pub-lished as D Dilithium3 Masked-Sign	Artix-7 XC7A100T-1CSG3, HORNET RIS,	1230000				check-source
S3-013	ML-DSA not stated in abstract three phases of ML-D	5 nm synthesis (Calipt, , 600					final-FIPS-name
S3-014	ML-KEM not stated in abstract three stages of ML-K	5 nm synthesis (Calipt, , 600					final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S3-015	ML-KEM and ML-DSA (sha n=256; q 12-bit (ML-KEM) a NTT/iNTT of one 256-	AMD Zynq Ul-traScale+ M, , 322	258				final-FIPS-name
S3-016	ML-DSA not stated in abstract first-order masked M	FPGA/area-delay study , ,					final-FIPS-name
S3-017	TLS 1.3 (classical, no not stated in abstract en-crypted single-val	not stated in abstract, ,					n/a
S3-018	PQ/T hybrid key agreem X25519MLKEM768 hand-shake key share	, ,				1216	n/a
S3-019	PQ/T hybrid key agreem X25519MLKEM768 hand-shake key share	, ,				1120	n/a
S3-020	PQ/T hybrid key agreem SecP256r1MLKEM768 hand-shake key share	, ,				1249	n/a

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S3-021	PQ/T hybrid key agreem SecP256r1MLKEM768 hand-shake key share	, ,				1153	n/a
S3-022	PQ/T hybrid key agreem SecP384r1MLKEM1024 hand-shake key share	, ,				1665	n/a
S3-023	PQ/T hybrid key agreem SecP384r1MLKEM1024 hand-shake key share	, ,				1665	n/a
S3-024	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 size	, ,				2420	final-FIPS-name
S3-025	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 size	, ,				1312	final-FIPS-name
S3-026	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 size	, ,				3309	final-FIPS-name
S3-027	ML-DSA ML-DSA-65 size	, ,				1952	final-FIPS-name
S3-028	ML-DSA ML-DSA-87 size	, ,				4627	final-FIPS-name
S3-029	ML-DSA ML-DSA-87 size	, ,				2592	final-FIPS-name
S3-030	ML-KEM ML-KEM-512 size	, ,				800	final-FIPS-name
S3-031	ML-KEM ML-KEM-512 size	, ,				768	final-FIPS-name
S3-032	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 size	, ,				1184	final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S3-033	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 size	, ,				1088	final-FIPS-name
S3-034	ML-KEM ML-KEM-1024 size	, ,				1568	final-FIPS-name
S3-035	ML-KEM ML-KEM-1024 size	, ,				1568	final-FIPS-name
S3-036	SLH-DSA SLH-DSA-SHA2-128s size	, ,				7856	final-FIPS-name
S3-037	SLH-DSA SLH-DSA-SHA2-128f size	, ,				17088	final-FIPS-name
S3-038	SLH-DSA SLH-DSA-SHA2-192s size	, ,				16224	final-FIPS-name
S3-039	SLH-DSA SLH-DSA-SHA2-192f size	, ,				35664	final-FIPS-name
S3-040	SLH-DSA SLH-DSA-SHA2-256s size	, ,				29792	final-FIPS-name
S3-041	SLH-DSA SLH-DSA-SHA2-256f size	, ,				49856	final-FIPS-name
S3-042	HSS/LMS LMS_LEVELS=2, LMS_HEIGHT=5 size	, ,				2644	n/a
S3-043	XMSS XMSS-SHA2_10_256 size	, ,				2500	n/a
S3-044	LMS SHA256_H10 (Winter-nitz par size	, ,				1912	n/a
S3-045	Ed25519 mono-cypher size	, ,				64	n/a

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S3-046	MAVLink 2 signing (SHA 32-byte secret key; 48-bit size	, ,				13	n/a
S2-0195	Kyber (pre-standard, N Kyber768 decaps	NUCLEO-F411RE (STM32F4, Cortex-M4, 96	1100000			1088	pre-standard
S2-0203	Dilithium (pre-standar Dilithium2 sign	NUCLEO-F411RE (STM32F4, Cortex-M4, 96	4663000			2044	pre-standard
S2-0204	Dilithium (pre-standar Dilithium2 verify	NUCLEO-F411RE (STM32F4, Cortex-M4, 96	1389000			2044	pre-standard
S2-0213	ECDSA secp256r1 (class secp256r1 verify	NUCLEO-F411RE (STM32F4, Cortex-M4, 96	6639000			64	n/a
S2-0218	Dilithium (pre-standar Dilithium2 sign	ESP32 DevKit v1, Xtensa LX6, 240					pre-standard
S2-0234	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 verify	Raspberry Pi Pico H (R, Cortex-M0+, 125	5497000				final-FIPS-name
S2-0244	ECDSA P-256 (classical P-256 verify	Raspberry Pi Pico H (R, Cortex-M0+, 125	40170000				n/a
S2-0248	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 key-gen+sign+verify (	Raspberry Pi Pico H (R, Cortex-M0+, 125					final-FIPS-name

id	scheme / parame-ter / op	device, core, MHz	cycles	stack B	code B	sz B	status
S2-0328	ML-KEM ML-KEM-768 decaps	STM32 NUCLEO-F439ZI, Cortex-M4, 168					final-FIPS-name
S2-0333	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 sign	STM32 NUCLEO-F439ZI, Cortex-M4, 168					final-FIPS-name
S2-0334	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 verify	STM32 NUCLEO-F439ZI, Cortex-M4, 168					final-FIPS-name
S2-0363	ML-DSA ML-DSA-44 verify	CHERIoT Ibex (Verilato, Ibex RISC-,	3674071	44672			final-FIPS-name

Appendix C. Sources not yet used for a table row

On 2026-10-12 the author supplied PDFs of ePrint 2019/844, 2020/470, 2021/781, 2022/323, 2025/366, 2026/312, 2026/1333 and 2026/2343, the NSA CNSA 2.0 FAQ, two UAE National Encryption Policy documents and a CISA quantum readiness document (docs/SOURCES_TO_UPLOAD.md). Rows from 2025/366 and 2020/470 are now in the table (stream S7, each value found in the PDF). The other papers are in hand but no number from them is in the table yet. Two supplied files (CISA, uaelegislation.gov.ae) are image only and need OCR or a text copy. The items below are still unretrieved.

Source	Why it matters	Note
NSA CNSA 2.0 algorithms advisory (separate from the FAQ)	algorithm set, dates, LMS/XMSS firmware-signing guidance	HTTP 403; only the FAQ was supplied
UAE National Cryptography Center algorithm list; Arabic-language sources; executive regulation text	UAE requirements for embedded systems	not found
NIST CAVP / CMVP PQC validation lists	which libraries are validated	JavaScript pages not extractable
Nordic, ST, NXP, Infineon, Arm product and documentation pages; Bluetooth Core spec; LoRa RP002; IEEE 802.15.4	exact device specs and PQC accelerator claims	blocked, JavaScript-only or paywalled
micro-ROS security documentation; DDS-XRCE specification	micro-ROS security status	guessed paths 404

Source	Why it matters	Note
MCUboot, PX4, ArduPilot GitHub issues and pull requests	whether PQC work is in progress	github.com HTML and API blocked
China ICCS; SAMA circular primary; NCA standards; Netherlands TNO handbook; ASD ISM cryptography chapter	other jurisdictions	blocked or 404
Uptane 2.1.0 and later; ISO/SAE 21434; Noise PQ variants	automotive/OTA PQC statements	not retrieved

Appendix D. Glossary for a newcomer

Authenticity / integrity: assurance that a message or file really came from the claimed party and was not altered. Different from secrecy. **Confidentiality / secrecy**: keeping content unreadable to outsiders. **Public-key cryptography**: schemes with a public key anyone can use and a private key held by one party. RSA, ECDH, ECDSA and Ed25519 are the classical ones; a large quantum computer running Shor's algorithm would break them. **Symmetric cryptography**: one shared secret key (AES, HMAC, SHA-256). Not broken outright by quantum computers; Grover's algorithm only weakens key strength (I rely on general knowledge here; the retrieved sources I used do not quantify this). **PQC (post quantum cryptography)**: ordinary algorithms, run on ordinary computers, designed to resist quantum attacks. **CRQC**: cryptographically relevant quantum computer, one big enough to break today's public key schemes. No date is asserted in this report. **KEM (key encapsulation mechanism)**: a way for two parties to agree on a shared secret key using public key methods. **ML-KEM (FIPS 203)** is the NIST standard KEM (formerly Kyber); sizes 512/768/1024. **Digital signature**: a value that proves who produced a message. **ML-DSA (FIPS 204)** (formerly Dilithium; levels 44/65/87) and **SLH-DSA (FIPS 205)** (formerly SPHINCS+) are NIST signature standards. **FN-DSA / FIPS 206** (Falcon) is not yet drafted as of the retrieval date. **Hash-based signatures**: signatures whose security relies only on hash functions. **LMS/HSS** and **XMSS/XMSS^MT** (NIST SP 800-208; RFC 8554, RFC 8391) are *stateful*; SLH-DSA is *stateless*. **Stateful**: the signer must remember which one time keys it has used and never use one twice, or forgeries become possible. The state lives with the signer (a build server or hardware security module), not the verifying device. **HSM**: hardware security module, a tamper resistant box that holds keys and performs signing. **Hybrid (PQ/T) / dual signature**: combining a classical and a post quantum algorithm so security holds if either survives. **Crypto-agility**: designing systems so algorithms can be swapped without rebuilding everything (NIST CSWP 39). **HNDL (harvest now, decrypt later)**: recording encrypted traffic today to decrypt after a quantum computer exists. Applies to secrecy, not to authenticity. **Mosca inequality**: if how long data must stay secret (X) plus how long migration takes (Y) exceeds the time until a CRQC (Z), you are already late. **Root of trust / boot ROM / OTP**: the first code and key a chip trusts; stored in mask ROM or one-time-programmable fuses, so it usually cannot be changed after manufacture. **Secure boot**: the chip refuses to run firmware whose signature does not verify. **OTA / SUIT / Uptane**: over-the-air firmware update; SUIT (IETF) and Uptane are update security frameworks and manifest formats. **COSE / X.509 / CMS**: formats for carrying signatures and keys; each has registered identifiers for LMS and ML-DSA. **MAVLink 2 signing**: a 13-byte trailer on drone messages holding a link ID, timestamp and a truncated 48-bit tag from a shared 32-byte key. **PX4 / ArduPilot**: the two main open source flight controller firmwares. **ROS 2 / SROS2 / DDS-Security**: robot middleware and its security layer; DDS-Security specifies RSA/ECC-based authentication. **micro-ROS**: ROS 2 for microcontrollers. **Cortex-M4F / M33 / M7 / M0+**: Arm microcontroller cores. M4F has hardware floating point; M33 adds Armv8-M features and TrustZone; M7 is faster; M0+ is the smallest and lacks the DWT cycle counter. **DWT CYCCNT**: a 32-bit

hardware counter of CPU cycles on M3/M4/M33/M7, used for timing. **pqm4**: a benchmarking framework and results for PQC on Cortex-M4 (to be archived read only in or after January 2027). **mlkem native / mldsa native**: maintained portable C libraries for ML-KEM and ML-DSA; used by the benchmark plan. **Stack / flash / RAM**: stack = temporary working memory during a call; flash = program storage; RAM = data memory. Often the limiting resource. **Cycles**: processor clock ticks; time = cycles / clock frequency. **Masking**: a defensive technique that splits secret values into random shares so single measurements of power or timing reveal nothing; it multiplies cost. **Side-channel / fault attack**: attacks on an implementation's physical behaviour (timing, power, glitches) rather than the maths. This report covers only the defensive concept. **Evidence labels**: *published* (from a retrieved source), *host measured* (run on a PC/server in the sandbox, not an MCU), *derived/estimated* (my arithmetic), *inference* (my reasoning).